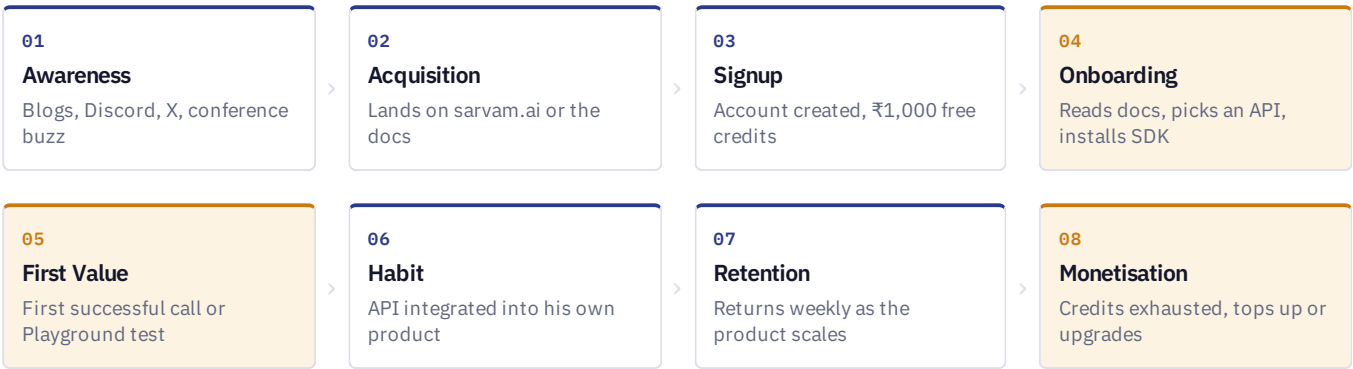


User Journey

The eight-stage path Rohan takes from first hearing about Sarvam to topping up credits — with the strength and the risk named at every stage.

PERSONA Rohan — developer	STAGES 8	WHY THIS PATH Highest-volume, most PM-influenceable funnel	WEAKEST LINK Onboarding → First Value
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4.1 The journey, end to end



AMBER STAGES CARRY THE HIGHEST IDENTIFIED FRICTION — ANALYSED IN DETAIL IN SECTION 9

4.2 Stage-by-stage diagnosis

STAGE	WHAT HAPPENS	CURRENT STRENGTH	CURRENT RISK
Awareness	Discovered via Discord, conference coverage, developer blogs	Strong community buzz following Epoch 2026	Awareness skews toward AI-insider audiences rather than the mainstream Indian developer population
Acquisition	Visits sarvam.ai or docs.sarvam.ai	Docs expose <code>/llms.txt</code> and per-page <code>.md</code> — genuinely developer-friendly	Discovery for non-AI-native developers — the long tail — is much weaker
Signup	₹1,000 free credits, universal across APIs	Frictionless and generous free tier	How much ₹1,000 actually buys is not obvious upfront, so perceived value is lower than real value
Onboarding	Docs → SDK install → pick an API	Python and JS SDKs, quickstart, Playground	With 6+ APIs, model and API selection is a real friction point — see Section 9
First Value	First successful API call	Public claim of a first request in under five minutes	No guided "use case → recommended API" path for undecided builders
Habit	Repeated calls as the feature ships	Usage-based cost scales with real usage	No in-dashboard nudge toward habitual return, such as weekly usage insights
Retention	Weekly active developer	Discord community sustains engagement	No public evidence of a retention-focused onboarding email or product-led growth loop

STAGE	WHAT HAPPENS	CURRENT STRENGTH	CURRENT RISK
Monetisation	Credits exhausted → top-up or upgrade	Transparent ₹ pricing table	The enterprise upsell path from self-serve is not clearly signposted

4.3 Where the journey actually breaks

Stage 4 — Onboarding HIGH Six API products, no router. The developer has to diagnose his own needs before he has experienced any value at all.	Stage 5 — First Value HIGH The five-minute claim only holds for someone who already knows which API to call. Undecided builders stall here.	Stage 8 — Monetisation HIGH Scaling developers hit a "contact sales" wall with no mid-tier plan to graduate into.
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READING THIS JOURNEY AS A PM

The strengths are real and should not be redesigned away — the free tier, the Playground, and the machine-readable docs are genuine assets. Every intervention proposed later in this study is additive: it routes the developer to the right starting point faster, rather than rebuilding what already works.